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FREE SPEECH IS IN RETREAT IN UK, WARNS TRUMP'S VP

By **Martin Beckford**
Policy Editor

THE demise of free speech in Britain poses a bigger risk than Russia does, the US Vice-President warned last night.

In a blistering speech, JD Vance told stunned European leaders and military chiefs that the biggest danger they faced was the 'threat from within' as they abandon their traditional values.

Donald Trump's right-hand man singled out the UK's 'thought crime' law that bans silent prayer near abortion clinics as an example of 'backsliding' on freedom of speech and religion.

But he also attacked censorship across the continent as well as the mass immigration that he said no one had voted for – while citing Brexit as proof of what voters did want.

In an astonishing address to the Munich Security Conference, where delegates had expected him to focus on ending the war in Ukraine, the vice-president said: 'The threat that I worry the most about vis-a-vis Europe is not Russia, it's not China, it's not any other external actor.'

'What I worry about is the threat from within. The retreat of Europe from some of its most fundamental values: values shared with

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– revealed by
his closest
confidant**

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